

Schwarzkopf Hair Care — GCC

A 90-day channel & shopper activation blueprint for Modern Trade, pharmacy and e-/quick-commerce

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Purpose. This is how I would land in the role: a fast read of the GCC hair-care shopper, a clear definition of Perfect Store by channel, a customer-led activation calendar, and the KPI/ROI discipline to prove it works — built to be executed with the Key Account and Sales teams from week one.

1. Shopper & category insight (GCC)

- **Climate-driven need:** Heat, sun and humidity 8+ months a year make damage, frizz and scalp care year-round needs — Schwarzkopf can own "repair & protect" (Gliss) and premium care (BC Bonacure) against a humidity-led benefit story.
- **Two shoppers, two missions:** High-frequency replenishment in grocery/hypermarket vs. advice-led discovery in pharmacy — each needs a different Perfect Store and mechanic.
- **Premiumisation + value polarity:** A large premium expat segment and a value-driven mass segment coexist; the range and pack-price architecture must serve both without trading down the brand.
- **Channels that matter:** Modern Trade (Carrefour/MAF, Lulu, Union Coop, Spinneys), pharmacy (BinSina, Aster, Life), e-tail (Noon, Amazon.ae) and quick-commerce (Noon Minutes, Talabat) — the latter now a real hair-care discovery channel for younger shoppers.
- **Seasonal peaks:** Summer (anti-frizz/sun protection), Ramadan & Eid (gifting, premium), back-to-school and DSF/GITEX retail moments anchor the calendar.

2. Perfect Store standards by channel

Definition: a single, measurable picture of success per channel tier — availability, visibility, pricing and activation — audited monthly and tied to KAM scorecards.

Channel	Perfect Store priorities
Hypermarket / Modern Trade	Hero SKU 100% availability · planogrammed block by benefit · 1 secondary display per quarter · price-pack compliance · promo ROI tracked
Pharmacy	Advice fixture for premium care · trained staff/sampling · BC Bonacure & repair range visible · GWP at till
E-tail (Noon / Amazon.ae)	A+ content on hero SKUs · 4.3★+ review health · search share on "shampoo/hair repair" · pack-shot & title compliance
Quick-commerce (Talabat / Noon Minutes)	Top-up bundles · hero-SKU availability · creator-led discovery tiles · impulse pricing

3. Key account & channel plan

Joint Business Plan (flagship — Carrefour/MAF): agree annual growth, distribution and share-of-shelf targets; build a quarterly promo grid and a retail-media plan; cluster stores (premium mall vs. community) for differentiated assortment.

Traditional Trade & distributor coverage: drive numeric distribution of hero SKUs through the distributor, with a simple Perfect Store checklist and incentive for must-stock list compliance.

Ways of working with KAMs: I act as the shopper/category engine behind the account teams — translating insight into customer plans, building the sell-in story, and owning post-evaluation.

4. 90-day trade activation calendar

Window	Activation	Channel	Mechanic	Objective
Wk 1–2	Onboarding & Perfect Store audit	All	Baseline scorecard + KAM 1:1s	Diagnose gaps
Wk 3–4	Hero-SKU availability fix	MT + e-tail	Must-stock list, A+ content refresh	Distribution +X pts
Month 2	Summer anti-frizz burst	MT + pharmacy	Secondary display + GWP + sampling	Sell-out uplift
Month 2	Creator-led q-commerce push	Talabat/Noon Min.	Influencer codes + bundle	Trial & basket size
Month 3	Ramadan/premium gifting pre-build	MT + pharmacy	Gift packs + premium endcap	Premium mix up
Month 3	Business review & scale	All	Promo ROI readout, scale winners	Lock Q4 plan

5. Shopper activation mechanics & NPD go-to-market

- **Mechanics toolkit:** GWP (gift-with-purchase), price-pack bundles, pharmacy sampling, endcaps/secondary displays, and creator-led q-commerce codes — chosen by shopper mission, not habit.
- **NPD launch playbook:** listing & Perfect Store readiness → launch burst (display + sampling + creator seeding) → e-tail A+ & review seeding → 6-week post-evaluation and scale decision.
- **Retail media:** fund always-on search and sponsored placements on Noon/Amazon.ae tied to the promo grid, so in-store and on-shelf-digital pull in the same direction.

6. KPIs, ROI & cadence

KPI	What it proves	Cadence
Numeric & weighted distribution (hero SKUs)	Availability foundation	Monthly
Perfect Store compliance %	Execution quality	Monthly audit
Sell-out uplift vs. baseline	Activation effectiveness	Per activity
Promo ROI / ROAS	Spend efficiency	Per activity + QBR
E-tail search share & review health	Digital shelf strength	Bi-weekly
Premium mix %	Value growth, not just volume	Monthly

Cadence: monthly business reviews with Sales, Supply Chain, Finance and Marketing; quarterly JBP checkpoints with key accounts; A&P managed to ROI throughout.

Why I can land this fast: *I already build trade & shopper plans by channel across 50+ markets at DoFreeze, ran 42 key accounts to +30% GMV QoQ at Alibaba's Miravia, and integrate brands into UAE modern trade and quick-commerce (Noon, Talabat, Careem, Deliveroo). This plan is the way I'd put that to work for Schwarzkopf in the GCC.*